

CHAPTER 4

One Habit. That's It.

Mary's breakfast was a grande vanilla latte and a slice of Starbucks banana bread.

Every morning. For about six years.

That was her breakfast when she was a VP. That was her breakfast when she got promoted. That was her breakfast when she got divorced. That was her breakfast when she met her second husband. That was her breakfast on her fortieth birthday.

Grande vanilla latte. Banana bread.

Four grams of protein. About 640 calories. Half of it sugar.

By 10 AM she was hungry again but pretended she wasn't because she had back-to-back meetings. By noon she was starving and irritable. By 1 PM she was eating whatever was in the conference room or at the Panera around the corner. A Mediterranean bowl one day. A sandwich the next. A pastry on the days she was too tired to decide.

By 3 PM she was crashing and grabbing whatever snack was on her assistant's desk.

By dinner she was ravenous and had no willpower left for the day.

By 9 PM she was in the pantry.

Sound familiar yet?

Mary had been trying to lose thirty pounds for four years when she came to me. She had tried three different diets in that time. She had joined two gyms. She had done a six-week challenge with a trainer.

She had never, in four years, changed her breakfast.

I want you to sit with that.

Mary is a VP at a company that does nine figures in annual revenue. She manages sixty people. She flies to Europe for meetings. She is not a woman who lacks competence.

She tried to fix her weight from the middle of the day down.

She tried to fix dinner. She tried to fix snacks. She tried to fix the late night kitchen walks. She tried gym sessions. She tried standing desks. She tried Peloton at 6 AM before work.

She was trying to put a fire out in the basement while a match was being lit on the top floor every single morning at 7:15 at a Starbucks drive-through.

It was never going to work. None of it. You cannot fix the afternoon if the morning is broken.

This is the thing nobody ever explained to her.

And nobody ever explained it to you either.

Here is the one rule. I'm going to tell you plain and I want you to write it on something.

40 grams of protein before noon. Most days.

That's it. That's the whole Phase 1.

No gym. No calorie counting. No meal prep Sunday. No macros. No apps. No tracking carbs. No tracking fats. No weighing food. No eliminating anything.

Forty grams of protein. Before noon. Most days.

Read it again.

Forty grams. Before noon. Most days.

That is the entire rule.

Now before your brain does what I know it's about to do, let me head it off.

Your brain is going to say "that's it? That can't be it. That's too simple. I've done way harder things than that and they didn't work. Why would this?"

Good. That's the right question. And I'm going to answer it.

The reason this works when the harder things didn't is because this is the one rule that fixes the morning, and fixing the morning fixes the day, and fixing enough days fixes the body.

Everything else is downstream.

Let me explain what happens to a woman's body when she hits 40 grams of protein before noon for about 10 days in a row.

I'm not going to quote studies. I don't have any to quote and frankly you don't need them. I'm going to tell you what I've seen happen with every single client I've ever put on this rule.

Day one she's surprised. Forty grams is more than she's used to. She's full by 10 AM. She skips her mid-morning snack not because she's willing her way through it but because she actually isn't hungry. She notices this. She's suspicious of it.

Day three she's still full. She forgets to eat her 10 AM snack two days in a row.

Day five the afternoon crash gets softer. That 3 PM slump that used to take her out every day? Still there but quieter. She doesn't reach for the office candy bowl as hard.

Day seven she sleeps better. Don't ask me the whole mechanism. I'll tell you plain: protein stabilizes blood sugar, and stable blood sugar means your body isn't spiking and crashing all day, and when you stop spiking and crashing all day your nervous system calms down, and when your nervous system calms down you sleep. Whatever the science, the outcome is consistent. Clients tell me this on day seven like clockwork.

Day ten the habit is starting to form.

Day fourteen the scale moves. Somewhere between two and five pounds usually. Some women lose more. Some lose less. But it moves.

And she hasn't done a single thing different except eat more protein in the morning.

She hasn't gone to the gym. She hasn't cut any food out. She hasn't counted a single calorie.

She just moved her protein earlier in the day.

That's the whole trick.

Now let me tell you why this works when nothing else did.

Most diets are about subtraction. No carbs. No sugar. No wine. No bread. No dairy. No gluten. No fried food. No snacks after 7 PM. EVER. The whole thing is a list of what you can't have.

This is addition.

You are not taking anything away from your day. You are adding something to it. You can still have your coffee. You can still have bread later. You can still have wine on Friday. You can still have dessert at your daughter's birthday party.

All I'm asking you to do is put a floor of protein under your morning.

That's it.

When you add a protein floor, three things happen that nothing in any diet you've ever tried has ever done for you.

One. You stop being hungry all morning. Protein digests slow. It sticks with you. You eat 40 grams at 7:30 AM and you are not starving at 10:30 AM. You are not starving at noon. This alone kills half the battle. You don't need willpower to skip the break room muffin if you're already full.

Two. Your blood sugar stabilizes. No spike and crash. No 3 PM slump. No "I need something sweet right now" crisis. Your energy across the day smooths out. You stop needing caffeine to get through the afternoon. You stop needing sugar at 3 PM to wake up.

Three. Your cravings drop. Not because you have more discipline. Your body stops asking. When you're protein-starved, your brain sends you after fast sugar and fast carbs because it's looking for fuel. When you're protein-full, it doesn't. You walk past the candy dish without performing any mental calisthenics. You just walk past it. That's what it feels like.

Most women have never felt what it's like to not fight their body. They've lived their whole adult life in a constant negotiation with cravings. When you take the cravings out, the whole game changes.

You didn't become stronger. You became full.

Let me be specific about what 40 grams looks like because I don't want you guessing.

Here are five breakfasts that hit it. Pick one. Rotate if you want. These are not recommendations. These are examples. Your actual protein source can be anything.

Breakfast One. Three eggs. Two slices of turkey bacon. One cup of cottage cheese. That's 43 grams. Five minutes to make. \$2.40 per serving.

Breakfast Two. Greek yogurt (one cup, plain, 2% or full fat, not the fake fruit kind). One scoop of protein powder stirred in. One hard boiled egg on the side. That's 41 grams. Three minutes. You can do this at your desk.

Breakfast Three. Protein shake (one scoop Core Power or equivalent, about 30 grams) plus two hard boiled eggs. That's 42 grams. Two minutes. You can do this in your car.

Breakfast Four. Four scrambled eggs with shredded cheese. Two slices of turkey sausage. That's 44 grams. Ten minutes.

Breakfast Five. One Premier Protein shake (30 grams) and two string cheese sticks (14 grams). That's 44 grams. Zero minutes. You can do this while you brush your teeth.

There is no excuse. Not time. Not money. Not skill. Not tiredness. One of these five works for every single woman reading this book.

Pick one.

Tomorrow morning.

Now let me talk about "before noon" because this is the part people want to argue with.

Women will say, "Sean, can I just hit 40 grams total during the day? Does it have to be in the morning?"

I have tested this with enough clients to tell you the answer. Yes it has to be the morning.

Here's why.

If you wait until dinner to eat protein, two things have already gone wrong.

One, you've already been hungry for four or five hours and your brain is now making food decisions in a hungry state. Hungry decisions are bad decisions. Every single time.

Two, the blood sugar rollercoaster has already started. You had a bagel or a muffin or a pastry or a coffee-with-sugar for breakfast, and now your sugar is crashing and you're reaching for anything to catch the crash. That afternoon snack attack at 3 PM? It was determined at 7:30 AM. Not at 3 PM.

When you hit 40 grams before noon, you're not just feeding yourself protein. You're turning off the hunger-and-crash machine for the rest of the day.

If you eat the same 40 grams at 7 PM at dinner? Different day entirely. The damage has already been done. All you're doing is adding protein on top of a day that was already a sugar tornado.

Morning protein is not the same calories as evening protein. It is not the same food. It is not the same effect on your body. The timing matters as much as the food.

Before noon. Write it down. Underline it.

Now let me talk about "most days." This is the one that saves women who have tried and failed at every diet in existence.

I did not say every day.

I did not say perfect.

I said most days.

Five out of seven days is a win. Six out of seven is a big win. Seven out of seven is a bonus, not a requirement. If you hit four out of seven, you're still ahead of where you were. The idea is to get everyday but don't sweat the small stuff. Get back on track if you miss a day.

A woman who hits 40 grams before noon five days a week for 12 weeks is going to lose weight. Period. Full stop. No gym. No other changes.

A woman who tries to be perfect and hits it seven days for one week and then zero days for two weeks because she "broke" the diet is going to lose nothing.

The enemy of this system is not missing a day. The enemy is quitting after you miss a day.

You are going to have a Tuesday where you sleep in and skip breakfast. You are going to have a Thursday where you're traveling and all you can get at the airport is a pastry. You are going to have a Sunday where your kids have a soccer tournament and you eat a hot dog from a stand because that is what was available.

All of that is fine.

Fine.

The next morning you just do it again. You don't restart Monday. You don't punish yourself on Wednesday. You don't double up. You don't catch up. You just do the next morning.

Most days wins. Perfect doesn't exist. I don't want perfect from you. I want consistent.

That is the single biggest mindset shift I need you to make before we move to Chapter 5. Every diet you've ever tried has demanded perfect from you. I'm telling you to stop trying to be perfect because perfect is what killed every previous attempt.

Good enough, done most days, for long enough, beats perfect done for two weeks.

Read that three more times.

Good enough, done most days, for long enough, beats perfect done for two weeks.

Now. Back to Mary.

I put her on the rule on a Monday.

She was resistant. Not because it was hard. It was easy. She kept saying "that can't be all. That can't be the whole thing." I kept saying yes it can.

Week one, she hit it four days out of seven. Missed Wednesday, Friday, and Saturday. I told her that was fine. Keep going.

Week two, she hit it six days out of seven. Skipped Sunday because she was out of town.

Week three, she sent me a text on a Thursday that said "I had a meeting run late and missed lunch entirely. I wasn't starving. What's happening to me."

I wrote back "That's your blood sugar being stable for the first time in six years."

She didn't understand it yet but she felt it.

Week four, she'd lost four pounds. No gym. No calorie counting. No other changes. She hadn't even dropped the Starbucks entirely — she still got the latte sometimes. She just added the protein to the morning first, and some days she wasn't hungry for the banana bread anymore. So she didn't get it.

Week eight, she'd lost eleven pounds. Still no gym.

Week twelve, she'd lost nineteen pounds. We had added Phase 2 by then, the eliminations. But the foundation? The foundation was always the morning protein.

Everything else we did in Phase 2 and Phase 3 worked because Phase 1 was in place.

You cannot skip Phase 1. You cannot leapfrog it. You cannot decide you're already past it because you've tried diets before. If you have not done 40 grams of protein before noon, most days, for 21 consecutive days, you have not done Phase 1.

Most women reading this book have never done Phase 1.

Not once.

That is why this book is about to change your life.

ONE THING TO DO TOMORROW MORNING

Tonight, go to the kitchen right now.

Check if you have one of these three things.

One. Eggs. At least a dozen.

Two. Greek yogurt. Plain. Not the sweetened one with fruit on the bottom.

Three. A protein shake. Premier Protein, Fairlife, Core Power, or any equivalent with at least 30 grams per bottle.

If you don't have at least one of those three things in your house right now, put this book down, open your phone, and add them to a grocery pickup order for tomorrow morning before 7 AM. Takes 90 seconds. Most grocery stores will have it ready by the time you're awake.

If you do have at least one of those three things, pull it out. Put it on the counter. Put it in front of the coffee pot. Put it where you will see it first thing when you walk into the kitchen tomorrow morning.

That's it.

Tomorrow morning, hit the 40 grams before you leave the house. Three eggs and a cheese stick. Or a shake and two eggs. Or a yogurt and a shake. Any combination that gets you to 40.

You will know you hit it because you won't be hungry at 10 AM.

That's the test.

One morning. One rule. That's the whole assignment.

In the next chapter, I'm going to walk you through the full three-phase system. Phase 1 is what you just learned. But Phase 2 and Phase 3 are what compound the results. I'm going to show you exactly what to do, when to do it, and, more importantly, what not to do yet. Because trying to do Phase 2 before Phase 1 is locked in is how every woman before you has failed. Don't skip. Don't speed up. We're going to do this right.

Turn the page.

CHAPTER 5

Phase 1: Fix the Machine

Here's what's actually wrong:

There is a specific thing happening inside your body right now that is making weight loss feel impossible, and until we fix that specific thing, no diet on earth will work on you.

You know the feeling I'm talking about. You eat lunch. You feel fine. Two hours later you're starving. Like actually starving. Shaky. Irritable. You'd fight someone for a cookie. You grab whatever's close — a granola bar, a latte, a handful of whatever's in the break room — and you feel okay for an hour. Then it happens again.

By 4 PM you're wrecked. By 6 PM you're eating dinner you don't remember choosing. By 9 PM you're in the pantry.

You think you have a willpower problem.

You have a blood sugar problem.

And until we fix your blood sugar, every other thing we try is going to fail. Because a woman whose blood sugar is spiking and crashing eight times a day cannot outrun that with discipline. Nobody can. Your body is writing checks your willpower cannot cash.

Phase 1 is not about losing weight.

Phase 1 is about fixing the machine underneath the weight.

Once the machine is fixed, the weight comes off on its own.

Let me tell you what blood sugar actually is, in words your twelve-year-old nephew could understand.

When you eat food, your body breaks it down into sugar. That sugar goes into your blood. Your blood takes it to your cells to use as energy.

That's the whole thing. That is what eating is. You eat, blood sugar goes up, body uses it, blood sugar goes back down.

That's what happens in a body that's working right.

In a body that's been running on coffee and bagels and Starbucks for twenty years, it doesn't work like that anymore. It works like this.

You eat a bagel. Your blood sugar doesn't just go up. It *spikes*. Like a line going straight to the moon. Your body panics because blood sugar that high is actually dangerous, so it dumps insulin into your bloodstream to bring the sugar down fast.

The insulin works. The sugar crashes. But it doesn't crash back to normal. It crashes below normal. Way below.

Now you're in the basement. Blood sugar too low. Your brain freaks out because low blood sugar is also dangerous. It sends you one message and one message only.

Eat something sweet. Right NOW.

That's the 10 AM cookie. That's the 3 PM candy dish. That's the 9 PM pantry walk.

It feels like hunger. It feels like willpower failure. It feels like a broken brain.

It is none of those things.

It is a machine begging for fuel because the last fuel you gave it burned too fast and left you empty.

Here's the part that'll make you mad when you see it.

Every time you spike and crash, your body stores a little bit more fat. That's what insulin does. Insulin's job is to pull sugar out of your blood, yes, but it also tells your body *store this as fat, we have too much*.

A woman who eats a bagel at 7 AM, a pastry with her latte at 10 AM, a sandwich at noon, pretzels at 3 PM, and pasta at 7 PM is spiking insulin five times in twelve hours. Her body is being told *store fat* five times a day.

Every day.

For years.

That's why you're not losing weight. It's not that you're eating too much. It's that your body has been told to store fat for so long that it doesn't know how to do anything else.

The diet industry told you to count calories. That's why calorie counting stops working for women over 35. Because it's not a calorie problem. It's a signal problem. Your body is getting the wrong signals, and the wrong signals tell it to hold onto every fat cell it's got.

Phase 1 rewrites the signals.

Three tools do it. Protein. Water. Glucomannan.

Let me walk you through each one.

TOOL ONE: 40 GRAMS OF PROTEIN BEFORE NOON

We already covered this in Chapter 4. I'm not going to give you the breakfast list again. You already have it. Go back and look if you need it.

One thing I want to add before we go further. Keep that breakfast under 400 calories.

I don't want you counting calories in Phase 1. You shouldn't be tracking anything yet. But I need to head off something I see a lot. Women hear "40 grams of protein before noon" and they build a 900-calorie breakfast. Four eggs, three slices of bacon, two pieces of toast, hash browns, a protein shake on the side, cheese on everything. They hit the 40 grams, but they also ate two meals in one sitting.

That's not the rule.

Three eggs and a cup of cottage cheese is 43 grams and about 340 calories. A Premier Protein shake and two hard-boiled eggs is 42 grams and about 280 calories. Greek yogurt with a scoop of protein powder and a string cheese is 41 grams and about 330 calories.

All of those are under 400. All of them hit 40 grams. All of them take under five minutes.

Now here's where some women get tripped up, so let me be clear. The rule is **40 grams of protein before noon**. The rule is not 40 grams at breakfast.

Before noon means anytime between the minute you wake up and 11:59 AM. That gives you options.

You can hit all 40 grams at breakfast and be done with it. That's the cleanest play for most women.

You can split it. 20 grams at breakfast around 7 AM, 20 grams at a light lunch around 11:30 AM. That works if you're not a big breakfast person.

You can back-load it. A smaller breakfast of 10-15 grams, then a bigger early lunch that gets you the remaining 25-30 grams before noon hits. That works if you like a lighter morning and a real meal around 11:30.

All three paths hit the rule. Pick whichever one fits your schedule and your appetite.

The only version that does not count is the version where you eat protein *after* noon and try to tell yourself it's close enough. It's not. The whole point of the rule is that your protein has to land *before* the blood sugar rollercoaster starts. I'll explain why in a minute.

The calorie ceiling still applies no matter how you split it. If you're splitting breakfast and lunch, your combined total before noon should still come in under 400 calories. That means both meals stay tight. Not two big meals stacked on top of each other. One 200-calorie breakfast and one 200-calorie early lunch. Or one 150/250 split. Or any combination that keeps the total under 400.

If your breakfast is creeping past 500 calories on its own, you're adding too many carbs or too much fat on the side. Cut the toast. Skip the hash browns. Pick one protein-dense base and one or two small sides. Keep it tight.

Under 400 calories total, before noon. 40 grams of protein total, before noon. Breakfast, lunch, or split — your call.

That's your Phase 1 protein rule.

Now what I really want to add here is the blood sugar piece, because that's the real reason this rule exists.

Protein is the slowest-burning fuel you can put in your body. It takes hours to digest. It doesn't spike your blood sugar. It doesn't crash your blood sugar. It just sits there feeding you, smooth, for four or five hours.

When you start your day with 40 grams of protein, you have laid down a blood sugar floor. Nothing can spike through it for hours. No crash is coming. Your 10 AM starving moment? Gone. Your 3 PM slump? Gone. Your 9 PM pantry walk? Quieter. Much quieter.

This is not willpower. You are not being stronger than yesterday. You are being fed correctly.

Here's why the 400 calorie cap matters in that blood sugar math. If you eat 900 calories in one sitting, even with protein in there, your body gets flooded. Insulin has to work overtime. You spike. You crash. The protein floor doesn't hold because you buried it under toast and hash browns. Keep the breakfast lean and tight around the protein, and the floor holds for hours.

A lean, high-protein, under-400 breakfast at 7 AM prevents the 3 PM crash that caused the 9 PM cave. You do not need to fight the pantry at 9 PM. You need to fight it at 7 AM. And fighting it at 7 AM is easy. It's just three eggs and a cheese stick.

You win the night by winning the morning.

That's the whole rule. That's the whole reason it works.

TOOL TWO: 110 OUNCES OF WATER A DAY

Now the water.

Most women reading this book are walking around dehydrated. I don't mean a little. I mean seriously dehydrated. You've been dehydrated for so long that you don't remember what fully hydrated feels like. You think what you feel right now is normal. It isn't.

Here's what dehydration does to a woman over 35.

It makes you hungry when you're not. Your brain cannot tell the difference between hunger and thirst. The signals go to the same place. When you're dehydrated, your brain sends you a hunger signal because it's trying to get water out of food. That 3 PM "I need a snack" feeling? Half the time it's water your body wants. Not food.

It slows your metabolism. A body that's short on water does not burn efficiently. It conserves. Every chemical reaction in your body needs water to run. Run low on water, everything runs slower. Including fat burn.

It makes you tired. Dehydration feels exactly like fatigue. You think you're tired, so you grab caffeine, which dehydrates you more, which makes you more tired.

It makes your cravings worse. A dehydrated brain craves sugar more aggressively than a hydrated one. That's not my opinion. Consistent pattern across every client I've ever had show this.

The rule is **110 ounces of water a day**. Not eight cups. Not sixty-four ounces. That old advice was made up for a generic adult in 1945. A woman over 35 trying to lose weight needs more than that.

110 ounces. That's about a gallon minus a little. Get a 40-ounce water bottle and drink three of them over the course of the day. Or a 32-ounce and drink three and change. Whatever. Measure it. Do not eyeball it.

Start the day with 20 ounces before your coffee. Not after. Before. This alone will change your morning.

The reason this works so fast: water dilutes your blood sugar. It doesn't fix the spike. But it blunts it. A hydrated woman spikes less hard and crashes less hard than a dehydrated one eating the same food.

You add the protein floor. You add the water. You have already killed half of your daily blood sugar roller coaster, and you haven't cut a single food out yet.

TOOL THREE: GLUCOMANNAN

Now let me tell you about the third tool. This one you haven't heard of, and that's good, because the diet industry would have ruined it by now if they had figured out how to put it in a shake and charge you ninety dollars for it.

Glucomannan is a fiber. It comes from a plant called konjac root. It's been used in Asia for hundreds of years as a food. In the West it shows up in stuff like shirataki noodles. But you can also just buy it in capsule form at any vitamin store or on Amazon for about fifteen dollars a bottle.

I buy the ones called NOW Foods Supplements, Glucomannan on Amazon.

Here's what it does.

When you swallow glucomannan with a big glass of water, it expands in your stomach. It turns into a gel. That gel sits in your stomach and takes up space. Physical space. It makes you feel full even when you've barely eaten.

More importantly for what we're trying to do, it slows down the absorption of sugar from whatever you ate with it. So if you take glucomannan before a meal and then eat something carb-heavy, the sugar from that meal enters your blood slower. Less spike. Less crash.

It is a blood sugar buffer in a capsule. And it is the single most underrated tool in fat loss for women over 35.

How to take it: 3 capsules of glucomannan, taken with at least 8 ounces of water, about 30 minutes before your last meal of the day.

What to expect:

You will feel fuller. You will not want to finish your plate. That's the point.

If you're someone who gets constipated when you change your diet, glucomannan will probably help with that too. It's fiber. It does what fiber does.

Two warnings. One, always take it with plenty of water. Without water, you can make yourself more constipated. Two, don't start it on a day you're doing anything important. Some women may get gas the first three or four days as their gut adjusts. It passes. But don't take your first dose on a Tuesday morning if you have a board meeting Tuesday at 2.

Why I have you take it: because Phase 1 is about fixing the blood sugar machine. Protein floors it in the morning. Water keeps it stable all day. Glucomannan buffers the last meal of the day. All three tools are aiming at the same target. Stable blood sugar. Stable blood sugar = no cravings = no pantry at 9 PM.

You get the mechanism. You execute it. The weight comes off.

WHAT PHASE 1 ACTUALLY LOOKS LIKE

Let me walk you through a day in Phase 1 so you can see it.

7:15 AM. You wake up. You drink 20 ounces of water before anything else. Before coffee.

7:30 AM. You make breakfast. Three eggs, two slices of turkey bacon, one cup of cottage cheese. 43 grams of protein. Eight minutes total.

8:00 AM. You drink your coffee. Black, or with a splash of milk, or with a half-scoop of protein powder stirred in if you want it creamy. No sugar. No sweet creamer.

10:00 AM. You're not hungry. This will feel weird the first few days. Keep drinking water.

12:00 PM. Lunch. Doesn't matter much what it is in Phase 1. Eat what you normally eat. We're not touching lunch yet. Just make sure you don't eat more than 40 grams of protein before noon.

3:00 PM. No crash. You might notice this. Write it down if you do. This is your machine starting to work again.

5:45 PM. Two glucomannan capsules with another 8 ounces of water.

6:00 PM. Dinner. Again, we're not touching dinner yet. Eat what your family eats.

9:00 PM. Pantry walk. Quieter than it used to be. Not gone. Quieter. You may still eat something. That's fine. We're not fixing 9 PM in Phase 1. We're fixing the morning. 9 PM gets handled by Phase 2.

That's Phase 1. Three weeks of that, most days.

THE MACHINE, FIXED

Remember Mary? The VP from the last chapter.

Week one on Phase 1, she did the protein five days out of seven. She did the water three days. She forgot the glucomannan half the time.

Week two she got more consistent. Protein six days. Water five days. Glucomannan most days.

Week three, she texted me on a Wednesday and said "I just realized I didn't eat my afternoon snack today and I don't need to. What is happening to me."

I said *that's your blood sugar being stable for the first time in twenty years.*

She said "why didn't my doctor tell me about this"

I said *because your doctor has nine minutes with you. They don't have time to fix the machine. They just treat the symptoms.*

By week three Mary had lost three pounds. Without changing what she ate for lunch. Without changing what she ate for dinner. Without going to the gym. Without cutting a single thing out.

She just fixed her morning. And her water. And added a \$15 bottle of fiber.

Three pounds in three weeks is not a life-changing number on its own. But the machine was now running right. And everything we added in Phase 2 and Phase 3 hit a body that was ready to respond. That's why she ended up 24 pounds down at week 12.

The first three weeks didn't feel like much. But the first three weeks made the next nine weeks possible.

Phase 1 is the foundation.

Do not skip it. Do not rush it. Do not "just" add eliminations in week two because you feel ready.

The machine needs three weeks.

Give it three weeks.

ONE THING TO DO TOMORROW

Before you go to sleep tonight, put three things on your kitchen counter.

One. A 32-ounce or 40-ounce water bottle. The biggest one you own. Fill it. Put it next to your coffee pot.

Two. Your breakfast protein. Eggs on the counter, yogurt in the fridge with a spoon already out, or a protein shake in the fridge ready to grab. Whatever protein you're using. Out. Visible.

Three. If you already ordered glucomannan, put the bottle next to your car keys or next to your lunch bag. If you haven't ordered it yet, open Amazon right now and order it. Search for "glucomannan capsules." Any brand. Aim for a bottle that has around 500mg to 1000mg per capsule. Fifteen to twenty bucks. Two-day shipping.

Tomorrow morning, in this order: water, protein, coffee. Not coffee first. Water first.

At 11:45 AM, before lunch, two capsules with water.

At 5:45 PM, before dinner, two capsules with water.

Throughout the day, keep refilling that water bottle until you've hit 110 ounces. That's about three and a half refills on a 32-ounce bottle.

One day. That's the whole assignment.

You are not fixing your body in one day. You are proving to your body that today is different. One day at a time, for 21 days, until the machine remembers how to run right.

In the next chapter, we move to Phase 2. By the time we get there, your blood sugar will be stable for the first time in a long time, and you'll be ready to start closing the biggest leaks in your day. We're going to take the first three NOs and introduce them one at a time over three weeks. This is where the scale starts moving for real.

Turn the page.